Daniel Okafor

Senior Backend Engineer

CONTACT

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SKILLS

Java
Kotlin
Go
Spring Boot
PostgreSQL
Redis
Apache Kafka
gRPC & REST
Docker
Kubernetes
AWS
Terraform
OpenTelemetry

LANGUAGES

English - native
Igbo - native
German - B1

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Software Engineering
University of Northfield, 2012 - 2014

B.Sc. Computer Science
University of Northfield, 2009 - 2012

PROFILE

Backend engineer with ten years of experience designing high-throughput payment and logistics services on the JVM and in Go. Comfortable owning a service from design to on-call, and mentoring engineers along the way.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer, Ledgerly

Mar 2021 - Present · Manchester, UK

- Lead a team of five building the card-settlement platform, processing 4 million transactions per day with 99.98% availability.
- Designed Settlement Engine, an event-driven service on Kafka and PostgreSQL that replaced a nightly batch job and cut settlement latency from 6 hours to 90 seconds.
- Reduced infrastructure spend by 28% by right-sizing Kubernetes workloads and moving cold data to S3.
- Introduced distributed tracing with OpenTelemetry, shortening mean time to resolve incidents by 40%.

Backend Engineer, Cargowise Labs

Jan 2018 - Feb 2021 · Manchester, UK

- Built Route Optimizer, a Go microservice that planned delivery routes for 12,000 vehicles and saved customers an estimated 9% in fuel.
- Migrated a Java monolith to 14 services behind a gRPC API gateway with zero customer-visible downtime.
- Cut p99 API latency from 800 ms to 120 ms by introducing Redis caching and query tuning.

Software Engineer, Brightwave Telecom

Sep 2015 - Dec 2017 · Leeds, UK

- Developed the Billing Gateway, a Spring Boot service generating invoices for 1.2 million subscribers each month.
- Wrote the integration test suite with Testcontainers, raising coverage from 35% to 82%.
- Mentored four graduate engineers through the company onboarding programme.

Junior Java Developer, Northgate Systems

Aug 2014 - Aug 2015 · Leeds, UK

- Implemented REST endpoints and batch jobs for an insurance quoting application.
- Automated deployments with Jenkins, reducing release time from half a day to 30 minutes.

TALKS & OPEN SOURCE

- Speaker, Manchester Java User Group (2022): "Event sourcing without the pain".

- Maintainer of kafka-replay-tool, a small open source CLI for replaying topic ranges.